

Jarrood Tran

Manager, AI & Factory Strategy

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SUMMARY

Strategy & Operations and Technical Program Manager. Running AI adoption across Tesla Energy manufacturing (10k employees): assess, build, ship, then hand off to a sustaining team. Lead a forward-deployed applied AI team for custom buildouts, with factory strategy and NPI cost-down beside that work. Prior Waymo (Alphabet) Strategy & Operations, Apple iPhone India launch, Tesla 4680 special projects, Amazon fulfillment ops.

SELECTED RESULTS

- Tesla: AI enablement across 10,000 Energy Manufacturing employees; forward-deployed applied AI team (20+ tools, 1,000+ users, ~\$1.6M productivity)
- Tesla: led 12-month NPI cost-down, \$260M annualized; \$156M incremental annual profit on a \$23M / 50+ initiative book; Megapack 3.2×
- Tesla: \$550M projected tariff exposure mitigated
- Apple: India revenue \$2B to \$10B; units 4.3M to 16.9M; exports 6 to 40+ countries

EXPERIENCE

Tesla | Manager, AI & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 – Present

10 direct reports. All production planning for the \$2.5B per quarter Megapack program. AI enablement for all of Energy Manufacturing (10k employees), which supports a ~\$4B per quarter Energy division.

- Lead AI enablement across Tesla Energy Manufacturing (10,000 employees): assess, build, ship, then hand off to a sustaining team.
- Stand up a forward-deployed applied AI team for custom buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ active users, ~\$1.6M productivity). Hiring manager for that team.
- Lead a 12-month NPI cost-down across materials, labor, and supplier contracts: \$260M annualized cost-down, \$156M incremental annual profit, on a \$23M / 50+ initiative book. Megapack scale 3.2×
- Mitigated \$550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning build plans and establishing FTZ / bonded-warehouse / product-changeover infrastructure.
- Own strategy on what we build, where we build it, and when we launch, plus regulatory and cost mitigation.

Waymo (Alphabet) | Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 – May 2023

- Translated Engineering Operations priorities into one decision system across hardware, software, fleet, product, and legal so leadership could move without ad-hoc reporting.
- Installed annual planning, OKRs, resource plans, business reviews, and decision milestones that surfaced bottlenecks without ad-hoc reporting.
- Returned to Tesla in Aug 2023 to lead AI and factory strategy for Energy Manufacturing.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 – Jun 2022

- Built the zero-to-one operating system for iPhone manufacturing in India under exacting quality, regulatory, and timing requirements.
- Shipped the ramp the operating system ran: revenue \$2B to \$10B, units 4.3M to 16.9M, exports expanded from 6 to 40+ countries.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 – Jun 2021

- Advanced Project Roadrunner (4680) from early battery-cell pilot to a production-ready platform.
- Installed stage gates, readiness reviews, and supplier coordination, then handed cross-functional launch ownership to engineering, production, and supply chain.
- Sustained Model 3 / Model Y rates through demand surges and supply disruptions.
- Designed and launched a \$3.5M/month Warehouse on Wheels logistics platform protecting battery and drivetrain flow.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 – Apr 2018

- Led a team of 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

SKILLS

Strategy & Operations | Technical Program Manager | AI enablement and adoption | Factory and operating strategy | Launch readiness | Capacity and cost economics | Zero-to-one manufacturing launches

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo. B.S. Business Administration, Finance (Cum Laude)